

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

DELLON DAVIS,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD OFFICER
CHRISTIAN ANGERON, Shield No. 14678, NYPD
OFFICER JONATHAN FORTE, Shield No. 21722, NYPD
POLICE OFFICERS JOHN/ JANE DOES NUMBERS
ONE THROUGH TEN,

Defendants.

SUMMONS

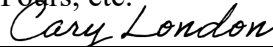
Index No.:

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of IncidentPlaintiff designates Kings
County as the place of trial.**To the above named Defendants:**

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
December 29, 2021

Yours, etc.



Cary London, Esq.

Shulman-Hill, PLLC

Attorneys for Plaintiff

1 State Street Plaza

15th Floor

New York, New York 10004

(212) 203-1090

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007
OFFICER CHRISTIAN ANGERON, 81 PCT, 30 Ralph Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11221
OFFICER JONATHAN FORTE, 81 PCT, 30 Ralph Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11221

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

----- X

DELLON DAVIS,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD OFFICER
CHRISTIAN ANGERON, Shield No. 14678, NYPD
OFFICER JONATHAN FORTE, Shield No. 21722, NYPD
POLICE OFFICERS JOHN/ JANE DOES NUMBERS
ONE THROUGH TEN,

Defendants.

----- X

INDEX NO.:

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

JURY TRIAL DEMANDED

Plaintiff DELLON DAVIS, by his attorneys, Shulman-Hill, PLLC, as and for his Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of Plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On January 2, 2021, at approximately 9:00 p.m., Plaintiff Dellon Davis, while lawfully in the vicinity of Reid Avenue and Monroe Street, County of Kings, New York, was subject to an unlawful arrest, detention, assault, battery and excessive use of force by defendant Police Officers, who subsequently falsely imprisoned Plaintiff and disseminated false statements enabling malicious prosecution of Plaintiff. In doing so, defendant Police Officers injured Plaintiff's face and knees and deprived Plaintiff of his constitutional, common law and statutory rights, in violation of the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York.

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff Dellon Davis is a resident of the state of New York.

3. New York City Police Officer Christian Angeron, Shield No. 14678, is and was at all times relevant herein an Officer with the New York City Police Department.

4. New York City Police Officer Christian Angeron, Shield No. 14678 is being sued in their individual and official capacity.

5. Currently and at all times relevant herein, New York City Police Officer Christian Angeron, Shield No. 14678 was assigned to the 81st Police Precinct of the NYPD.

6. New York City Police Officer Jonathan Forte, Shield No. 21722 is and was at all times relevant herein an Officer with the New York City Police Department.

7. New York City Police Officer Jonathan Forte, Shield No. 21722 is being sued in their individual and official capacity.

8. Currently and at all times relevant herein, New York City Police Officer Jonathan Forte, Shield No. 21722 was assigned to the 81st Police Precinct of the NYPD.

9. New York City Police Officers John/Jane Does Numbers 1 through 10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.

10. New York City Police Officers John/Jane Does Numbers 1 through 10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

11. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.

12. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.

13. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the CITY OF NEW YORK in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.

14. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and THE CITY OF NEW YORK has failed to pay or adjust the claims.

15. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

16. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

17. On January 2, 2021, at approximately 9:00 p.m., Plaintiff was lawfully at the intersection of Reid Avenue and Monroe Street, County of Kings, New York, when the defendant Police Officers unlawfully stopped, searched, arrested, assaulted and battered Plaintiff without legal justification.

18. Plaintiff was a passenger in a vehicle that was stopped without legal justification.

19. Defendant officers unlawfully detained and searched Plaintiff, the other passengers, and the vehicle.

20. Defendant officers then arrested Plaintiff without legal justification.

21. In the course of arresting Plaintiff, defendant officers punched him in the face; slammed his head on the vehicle; threw him to the ground and then put a knee in his back.

22. As a result of this excessive force, Plaintiff suffered physical injuries including cuts, abrasions and contusions to his face and knees.

23. Defendant Officers transported Plaintiff to the 81st Precinct where they remained for at least 12 hours.

24. Plaintiff was then transported to Central Booking where he remained for approximately 36 more hours.

25. Plaintiff did not go before a Judge for arraignment until January 4, 2021.

26. In the interim, Defendant Officers transmitted false statements regarding the Plaintiff being in possession of a firearm to the Kings County District Attorney's Office via prosecutors in the Early Case Assessment Bureau.

27. Defendant Officer Forte swore out a false complaint against the Plaintiff on January 3, 2021 alleging that Plaintiff was "in possession of a loaded firearm."

28. Plaintiff never possessed any firearm on January 2, 2021.

29. Defendant Officer Forte's false complaint stated, as grounds for these false claims, false statements attributed to Defendant Officer Angeron.

30. That false complaint was presented to the arraigning Court on January 4, 2021.

31. As a direct result of such falsehoods, Plaintiff had bail set in the amount of \$15,000; an amount he was unable to post.

32. Plaintiff remained in jail until January 7, when he was released pursuant to CPL § 180.80.

33. Plaintiff's criminal case was dismissed and sealed on August 6, 2021.

34. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of Plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent their fellow officers from unjustifiably assaulting, battering, and using excessive force against Plaintiff.

35. The unlawful assault, battery, and use of excessive force by the individually named defendants caused Plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological and emotional trauma.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligence

36. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

37. Defendants owed a duty of care to Plaintiff.

38. To the extent defendants claim that the injuries to Plaintiff by the defendant police officers was unintentionally caused and that the force used by the defendants against his was unintentional, then the defendants breached that duty of care by injuring his face and knees.

39. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

40. All of the foregoing occurred without any fault or provocation by Plaintiff.

41. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

42. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

43. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION
Unlawful Stop, Question, and Search

44. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

45. The illegal approach, stop and search employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

46. The conduct of defendants in approaching, stopping, and searching Plaintiff was performed under color of law and without any reasonable suspicion of criminality or other constitutionally required grounds.

47. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

48. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

49. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION
Violation of Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights:
Unlawful Seizure and Deprivation of Liberty

50. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

51. The individually named police officer defendants, while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused Plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, and falsely imprisoned, and maliciously prosecuted without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of Plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

52. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

False Imprisonment

53. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

54. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and, in fact, confined Plaintiff, and Plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, Plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

55. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

56. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

57. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

58. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional, physical and psychological injuries.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth And Fourteenth Amendment Rights: Excessive Force

59. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

60. The use of excessive force by defendants by, amongst other things, roughly handcuffing, grabbing and throwing Plaintiff onto a vehicle and onto the ground, punching him in the face and shoving a knee in his back constituted objectively unreasonable physical seizures of Plaintiff in violation of his rights under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

61. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of his employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Assault

62. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

63. Defendants, their agents, servants and employees, acting within the scope of their employment, intentionally, willfully and maliciously assaulted Plaintiff in that they had the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and intentionally did a violent and/or menacing act which threatened such contact to the Plaintiff, that such acts caused apprehension of such contact in the Plaintiff.

64. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

65. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

66. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

67. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional, physical and psychological injuries.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Battery

68. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

69. Defendants, their agents, servants and employees, acting within the scope of their employment, intentionally, willfully and maliciously battered Plaintiff, when they, in a hostile and/or offensive manner, grabbed and threw Plaintiff onto a vehicle and then onto the ground, punched him in the face and shoved a knee in his back, brutally effecting an arrest of Plaintiff without his consent and with the intention of causing harmful and/or offensive bodily contact to the Plaintiff and caused such battery.

70. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

71. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

72. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

73. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional, physical and psychological injuries.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress

74. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

75. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to Plaintiff. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

76. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed Plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

77. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

78. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

79. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

80. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional, physical, and psychological injuries.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision

81. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

82. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

83. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional, physical, and psychological injuries.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene

84. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

85. The defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

86. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

87. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff's suffered physical injury, his liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear of his safety, he did not receive necessary medical treatment, and he was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.

88. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

89. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

90. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

91. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional, physical, and psychological injuries.

ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Fourth And Fourteenth Amendment Rights: Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process

92. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

93. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

94. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

95. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

96. In withholding/creating false evidence against Plaintiff, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, Defendants violated Plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free to deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

97. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, and deprivation of his constitutional rights.

98. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

99. The City, as the employer of the officer Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

100. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of Defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries including, but not limited to: emotional and psychological injuries.

TWELFTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Malicious Prosecution

101. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

102. The acts and conduct of the Defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the United States Constitution.

103. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against Plaintiff.

104. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against Plaintiff and for each of the charges for which they were prosecuted.

105. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in Plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned date.

JURY DEMAND

106. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff DELLON DAVIS demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law. That the Plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

Dated: New York, New York
December 29, 2021

By: Cary London
Cary London, Esq.
Shulman-Hill, PLLC
Attorneys for Plaintiff
1 State Street Plaza
15th Floor
New York, New York 10004
(212) 203-1090

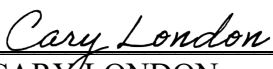
TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007
OFFICER CHRISTIAN ANGERON, 81 PCT, 30 Ralph Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11221
OFFICER JONATHAN FORTE, 81 PCT, 30 Ralph Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11221

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

CARY LONDON, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a partner of the law firm of **SHULMAN-HILL PLLC**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because Plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
December 29, 2021



CARY LONDON